Factor-base yield and Pollard rho across the GF(2^83) Koblitz isogeny class

Date 2026-10-16. Study directory `cryptanalysis:ecc2k130/research/volcano-m83-twist/`, extending `cryptanalysis:ecc2k130/research/volcano-m83/` (the a2 = 0 floor census) to the a2 = 1 twist, field representations and Pollard rho. Frozen protocol: `PROTOCOL.md`. Stage diagnostic only: no IC1 candidate, no end-to-end index-calculus run, `candidate_id: null`.

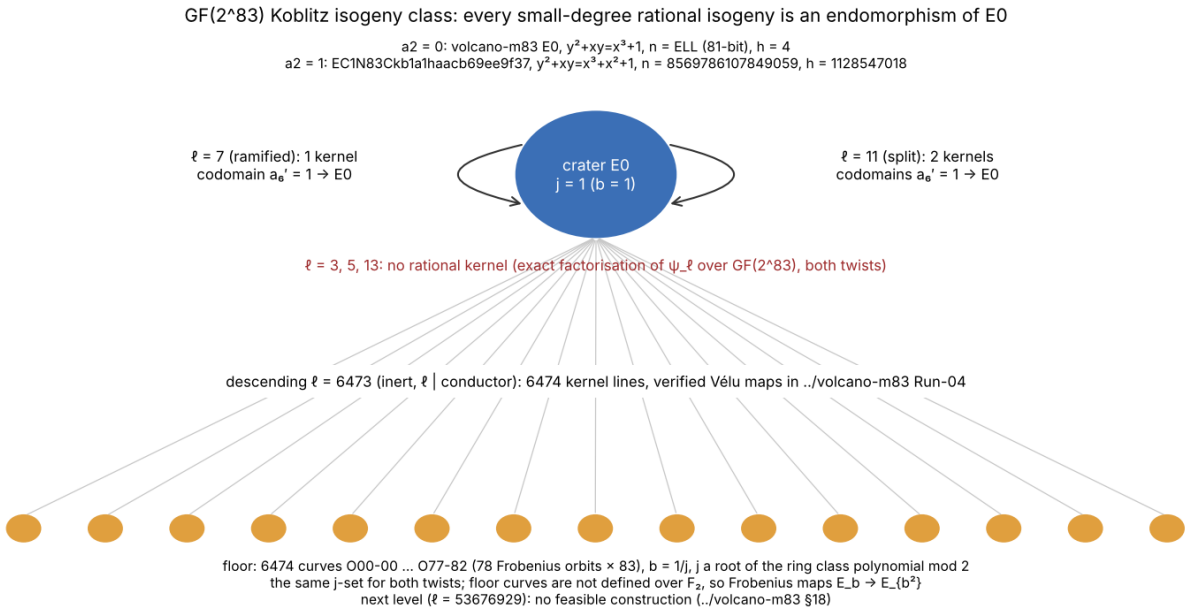
Question and answer

Does a curve reachable by isogeny from the GF(2^83) Koblitz curves, or a field representation of the Koblitz curve, give a factor base that clearly beats the Koblitz crater? **No.** No candidate cleared the frozen gate (+0.1 % for a2 = 0, +5 % for a2 = 1, equal cardinality S = 1856, k = 12), on 2 × 6474 floor curves and 2 × 200 representations. Floor curves also lose the 83-fold Frobenius folding. By the protocol, the end-to-end N83 run against the 28.688 ms K3425/root4 baseline (`crypto:research/n83_final_tournament_results_20261015`) is not opened.

Curves

- a2 = 0: $y^2 + xy = x^3 + b$, n = ELL = 241785163923079621668568 9 (81-bit), h = 4. Crater b = 1 is ../volcano-m83 E0 (no EC1 ID registered in `experiments/ic-candidate-catalog/curves.yaml`).
- a2 = 1: $y^2 + xy = x^3 + x^2 + b$, n = 8569786107849059 (53-bit), h = 1128547018 = 2·10459·53951. Crater b = 1 is `EC1N83Ckb1a1haacb69ee9f37` (crypto N83 instance).
- Field $F_2[z]/(z^{83} + z^7 + z^4 + z^2 + 1)$ for both. Floor: the 6474 conductor-6473 curves O00-00 … O77-82 of ../volcano-m83 (b = 1/j, j a root of the ring class polynomial mod 2). The j-set does not depend on the twist, so each floor j gives one a2 = 0 and one a2 = 1 curve; every curve passed [N]R = O in the census.

Structure (derived, exactly computed)

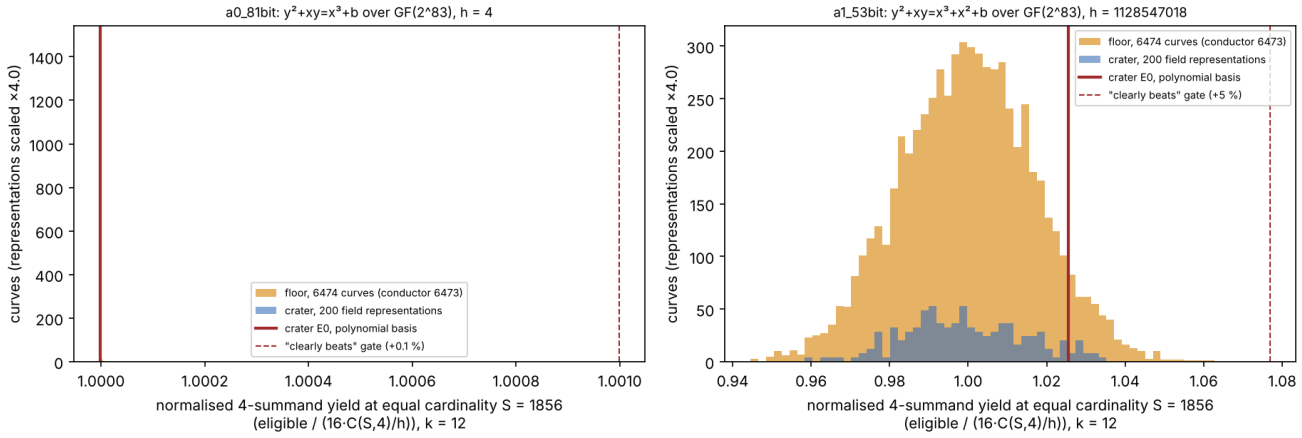


$t^2 - 4q = -7c^2$, $c = 6473 \cdot 53676929$, and $Q(\sqrt{-7})$ has class number 1, so the crater has End = O_K and every horizontal isogeny of degree prime to c is an endomorphism. `scripts/s00_small_isogenies.py` factors ψ_ℓ over GF(2^83) for $\ell = 3, 5, 7, 11, 13$ on both twists: $\ell = 3, 5, 13$ give no rational kernel; $\ell = 7$ gives 1 kernel and $\ell = 11$ gives 2, and every codomain has $a_6' = 1$ (the crater itself, with the same abscissae in this normal form). The first other curves are the degree-6473 floor (verified maps in ../volcano-m83 Run-04). The F_{83} toy's 7-isogeny/rescaling tournament therefore has a single candidate on GF(2^83).

Instrument and control (measured)

`native/f83x.c` (x86-64 PCLMUL) computes the factor base of rational x in span(basis), cofactor tags (log of [n]P in E(F_q)[h], Pohlig–Hellman, homomorphism self-check), and the exact number of (4-subset, sign vector) with tag sum 0 mod h, the eligible4 count of ../volcano-m83 run06. `scripts/control_run06.py` reproduces all 24 run06 counts exactly (all_match = True). Normalised yield Y = eligible / (16·C(S,4)/h); for a2 = 1 the Poisson sd of Y at S = 1856 is about 0.012.

Four-summand yield census (measured)



a2 = 0 (h = 4):

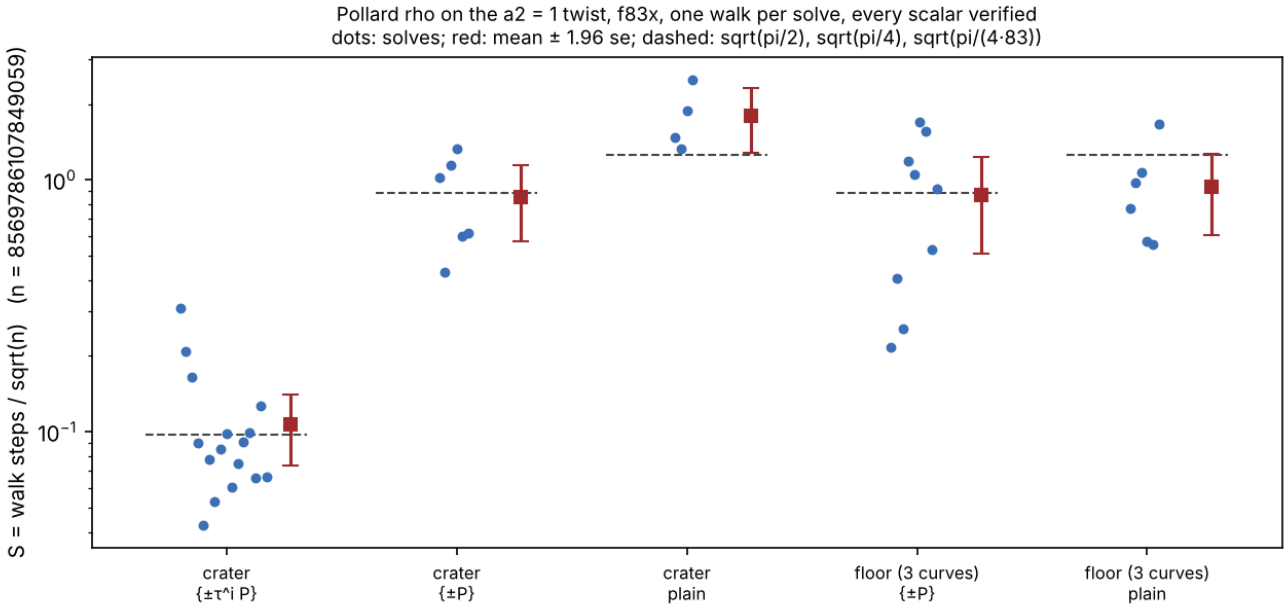
arm	Y at S = 1856	vs crater
crater E0, polynomial basis	0.999998	—
floor mean ± sd (6474 curves)	1.000000 ± 9.9e-07	+0.0002 %
best floor curve O05-46	1.000024	+0.0025 %
crater, 200 field representations: mean ± sd	1.000000 ± 1.5e-06	+0.0002 %
best representation	1.000016	+0.0018 %

a2 = 1 (h = 1128547018):

arm	Y at S = 1856	vs crater
crater E0, polynomial basis	1.025606	—
floor mean ± sd (6474 curves)	0.999845 ± 0.017	-2.5118 %
best floor curve O66-54	1.062818	+3.6282 %
crater, 200 field representations: mean ± sd	0.999368 ± 0.015	-2.5583 %
best representation	1.035052	+0.9210 %

Crater rank from top among the floor: a2 = 0 6178 of 6475, a2 = 1 415 of 6475. Natural factor-base sizes on the floor: a2 = 0 1922–2175, a2 = 1 1920–2173 points. For a2 = 1 the observed floor sd of Y is 0.0171, 1.43× the Poisson sd (0.0120) of a count near 6986; the excess is observed, not explained here (overlapping 4-subsets make eligible counts dependent, which is one candidate). The best floor curve, O66-54, is +3.6282 % above the crater, inside the gate; no replication was preregistered, so it is not promoted and no curve is named a lead.

Pollard rho on the a2 = 1 twist (measured)



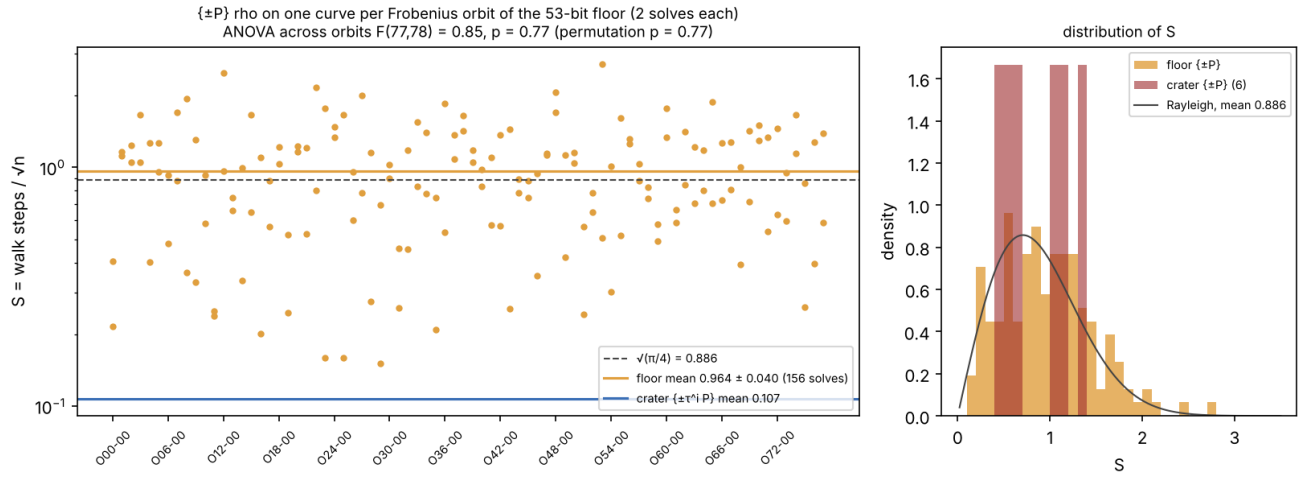
f83x rho: r = 32 adding walk, next-index rule and doubling escape against fruitless cycles, distinguished points on bits 1..d of the canonical x (bit 0 is pinned: Tr = bits {0, 79, 81} and Tr(x) = Tr(a2) on the odd-order subgroup), one walk per solve, fixture scalar recovered and checked by [k]G = Q on every solve. Yield of rho = collisions per step, reported as S = steps / √n. Priced columns charge the canonicalisation squarings at 0 / 0.1 / 1 GAE each (crypto CLAUDE.md §5a band).

arm	solves	S (± se)	theory	squarings / step	S priced at 0 / 0.1 / 1 GAE	wall s / solve
crater E0, classes {±τ^i P}	16	0.107 ± 0.017	0.097	123.0	0.107 / 1.43 / 13.3	29.4
crater E0, classes {±P}	6	0.855 ± 0.146	0.886	0.0	0.855 / 0.855 / 0.855	98.4
crater E0, plain	4	1.796 ± 0.263	1.253	0.0	1.8 / 1.8 / 1.8	200.4
floor O00-00/O39-00/O77-82, {±P}	9	0.869 ± 0.184	0.886	0.0	0.869 / 0.869 / 0.869	100.3
floor O00-00/O39-00/O77-82, plain	6	0.935 ± 0.170	1.253	0.0	0.935 / 0.935 / 0.935	105.1

The crater's τ classes give S ≈ 0.107 against 0.855 for ±P, the √83 factor. Floor curves have no τ over F_2 and run as ±P rho. Across the 0–1 GAE band the {±τ^i P} and {±P} arms do not keep one order (0.107 < 0.855 at 0 GAE, 13.3 > 0.855 at 1 GAE), so the band rule does not rank them; the single-core, contended wall times (29.4 s against 98.4 s) are exploratory, not a tiered timing claim. The plain-walk means sit above and below theory with 4–6 solves each; their intervals are wide.

The k = 12 subspace base is not competitive with rho: collecting 2248 rows needs at least 2^50.7 uniform queries against 2^23.2 measured τ-class rho steps. That is the expected scale gap for a 2^12-point domain; the N83 pipeline uses ≈ $5.7 \cdot 10^5$ projected points and a root index. The a2 = 0 twist needs ≈ 2^37 τ-class rho steps (prediction, not run).

Pollard rho over the whole 53-bit floor (measured; protocol addendum)



The 6474 floor curves form 78 orbits of 83 under b → b², and (x, y) → (x², y²) is a group isomorphism $E_b \to E_{b^2}$, so one representative per orbit (O00-00 … O77-00) covers the floor up to that isomorphism. `scripts/rho_floor.py` ran 156 {±P} solves (2 per orbit, seeds 1000 and 1001), all verified (True), 0 restarts, 1.39e+10 walk steps in all.

arm	solves	S (± se)
floor, 78 orbit representatives, {±P}	156	0.964 ± 0.040
crater E0, {±P}	6	0.855 ± 0.146
crater E0, {±τ^i P}	16	0.107 ± 0.017
theory {±P}	—	0.886

- Orbits are homogeneous: one-way ANOVA F(77, 78) = 0.85, p = 0.77; a 20000-draw permutation test gives p = 0.77. Two solves per orbit cannot rank orbits, so no orbit is named a lead (lowest orbit means O11-00 0.24, O00-00 0.31, O31-00 0.36 are draws).
- The floor's {±P} rho costs 9.00× the crater's τ-class rho, against √83 = 9.11: the Frobenius factor the floor loses, as derived.
- The pooled floor mean sits 2.0 se above √(π/4). Observed and not explained here; an r = 32 adding walk with fruitless-cycle escapes is expected to sit slightly above the random-mapping constant, which this run does not test.
- Not run: all 6474 curves individually (~45 h on this VM); the a2 = 0 floor (~2^37 steps per solve).

What this does not show

- No end-to-end IC row and no IC1 candidate: yields are stage diagnostics.
- The 53676929-level curves and isogenies of degree > 13 other than 6473 were not examined (../volcano-m83 §18: no feasible construction).

- Only polynomial-subspace factor bases at k = 12 and representations of the form span{1, ρ, ..., ρ^11} were screened.
- Rho timings are one shared cloud core, exploratory tier.

Graphs checked

New: `outputs/structure.svg`, `outputs/yield-census.svg`, `outputs/rho-a1.svg`, `outputs/rho-floor-a1.svg` (rendered PNG beside each). ../volcano-m83 figures and `experiments/volcano-ic/figures/` were checked and remain current: no verified edge or curve was added and the a2 = 0 census agrees with ../volcano-m83 Run-06.

Reproduce

```
make -C native
cd scripts
python3 control_run06.py && python3 s00_small_isogenies.py
python3 census.py floor --a2 0; ./run_rest.sh; python3 rho_panel.py
python3 analyze.py && python3 diagram.py
cd ../report && python3 make_report.py && python3 build_report.py
```